

Activity 4: Write Better Prompts: Goal, Context, Source, Expectations

Duration: 35 minutes **Roles:** Daniel Lim writing prompts, Priya Nair reviewing

Scenario

The shortlist is Serene Ng and Zhi Wei Chua (after a phone screen). Priya typed 'give me interview questions for a data analyst' into Copilot and got a generic list. Show her how a complete prompt produces questions that fit FutureTech's role.

Goal and output

A before-and-after prompt pair, a reviewed set of questions and one saved prompt the team can reuse.

Tools and data to use

Copilot Chat or Copilot in Word | JD - Senior Data Analyst | your criteria from Activity 2

Use only the practice files supplied. Never enter real candidate information or company-confidential details into Copilot.

Step by step

Step 1

Run Priya's prompt exactly: 'Give me interview questions for a data analyst.' Save the answer.

Step 2

With your partner, mark what is wrong: too generic, not about FutureTech's problem (reports that don't reconcile), leading, or asking two things at once.

Step 3

Rewrite it with Goal, Context, Source and Expectations (template in the Lab Prompt Pack). Put FutureTech's situation in Context and /JD - Senior Data Analyst in Source.

Step 4

Put the fairness rules in Expectations: no personal or protected topics - including career breaks - and one requirement per question.

Step 5

Run the new prompt and compare the two answers side by side.

Step 6

Ask Copilot: 'Check these questions against my must-haves and improve the two weakest.'

Step 7

Save the prompt (Save prompt in Copilot Chat if available, or a shared Word document) so Priya can reuse it for the next analyst hire.

Templates in this folder

- prompt_before_after.txt
- question_review.csv

If something goes wrong

If Copilot's answer is generic, unfair or not based on your files, keep a copy, add the missing detail to your prompt (goal, context, source or expectations) and try again. If you cannot sign in or an agent does not open, tell your trainer and continue with the templates in this folder - never use real candidate data instead.

You are done when you have

A before-and-after prompt pair, a reviewed set of questions and one saved prompt the team can reuse.